Environmental Awareness: How New Zealand Protects Its Nature

Target Audience: B1+ / B2 (Upper-Intermediate)
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach (Safonova)
Lesson Objectives:

- Educational (Content): Understand New Zealand's environmental goals (Predator Free 2050) and how modern technology (AI) is used to protect native wildlife.
- Linguistic (Language): Practice vocabulary related to ecology and technology (e.g., *predator, native, pest, trap, affordable, conservation*), and develop listening skills for gist and specific details.
- Socio-cultural: Develop environmental awareness and compare New Zealand's approach to conservation with the environmental challenges in the students' home country (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the concept of environmental protection.	5 min	Teacher shows a picture of a Kiwi bird and a picture of a rat/stoat. Ask: *"What is the connection between these two animals? Why is one a threat to the other in New Zealand?"*	Pictures of a Kiwi bird and a predator.
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary needed for the listening.	7 min	Students match words: *predator, native, pest, trap, affordable*. Look at the title *"Predator Free 2050"*. What do you think this means?	Vocabulary Match, presentation slide
Listening	Develop listening skills for general understanding (gist).	5 min	Students listen to the first fragment (0:00 – 2:30). They answer questions	The Kiwi AI tech saving our native bush from pests | RNZ
Listening	Develop listening skills for specific details.	8 min	Students listen to the second fragment (5:00 – 8:00). They answer	Audio

			question. *Teacher may pause the audio to allow students to take notes.*	
Listening	Develop listening skills for specific details and understanding the problem.	5 min	Students listen to the third fragment (15:00 – 17:00). They answer questions	Audio
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop speaking skills through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	15 min	Round Table Discussion. Students work in groups. They discuss: *"Which is more important: spending money on expensive AI technology or on simple community projects to protect nature? Why?"* Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"Does your country have similar environmental problems? What do you think is the best way to protect nature in your country?"*	Discussion questions, board
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	*"Why is it important to protect native animals and plants?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"What is the biggest environmental problem in your country? What should the government do?"*	Notebooks

Match the words (1-5) with their definitions (A-E).

Word	**Letter**	**Definition**
1. Predator	[ ]	A. An animal that naturally lives in a particular place.

2. Native	[ ]	B. Cheap enough that people can afford to buy it.
3. Pest	[ ]	C. An animal that hunts and kills other animals for food.
4. Trap	[ ]	D. A device used to catch and hold animals.
5. Affordable	[ ]	E. An unwanted animal or insect that damages crops or causes problems.

Vocabulary Match

1. C
2. A
3. E
4. D
5. B

Listen to the three fragments from the RNZ podcast and answer the questions.

Fragment 1 (0:00 – 2:30): The Problem

1. What is the main goal of "Predator Free 2050"?

   _____

2. Why are predators (like rats and stoats) dangerous for New Zealand?

   _____

Fragment 2 (5:00 – 8:00): The Solution

3. How does the new AI technology help? What does it actually do?

   _____

4. _____

Fragment 3 (15:00 – 17:00): The Challenge

4. True or False: The technology is cheap and easy for everyone to use. _____
5. What is the biggest problem for local communities?

Answers:

1. Goal: To remove all introduced predators (rats, stoats, possums) from New Zealand by the year 2050.
2. Why dangerous: They kill native birds (like the kiwi) and destroy their eggs/nests.
3. How AI helps: It can automatically identify and trap predators, or monitor the forest without humans needing to check traps constantly.
4. True or False: False (The podcast mentions it is expensive and needs to become more affordable).
5. Challenge: The cost (it needs to be affordable for local community groups).

Round Table Discussion (Freer Practice)

Task: Work in groups. Discuss the questions below.

1. The Cost of Protection: The podcast mentions that AI technology is expensive. Do you think it is better to spend money on high-tech solutions or on simple local projects (like planting trees or community clean-ups)? Why?
2. Personal Responsibility: What can ordinary people do to protect native animals and the environment in their daily lives?
3. Dialogue of Cultures: Does your country have similar environmental problems (e.g., invasive species, pollution)? What can your country learn from New Zealand's Predator Free 2050 plan?

Useful phrases for discussion:

- *From my point of view...*
- *I totally agree with the idea that...*
- *I see your point, but I think...*
- *In my country, for example...*